



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Victory Academy Ocala
School Website: <https://victoryacademyocala.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Victory Academy Ocala (Ocala, FL) presents as a Christian, classical-leaning program that foregrounds a Trivium-inspired framework (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) within a Christ-centered, classical curriculum. Public materials consistently describe the school as Christ-centered with a Christian worldview, integrates Scriptural study, and emphasizes a progression through the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), Latin study, and four historical periods. There is clear attention to formation of character, virtue, and a holistic "body, mind, and spirit" mission. The school also communicates family partnership with explicit language about parental involvement and "Parental Responsibility," along with a stated aim of forming students for college-bound futures within a Christian framework. These signals align Victory Academy with a classical education orientation, though some elements (e.g., modern programs like MakerSpace and Winterim, and explicit emphasis on college-bound outcomes) introduce non-classical features that temper a fully "pure" classical profile. Overall, the school scores CLASSICAL with a notable SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL nuance in pedagogy and program balance.

Key methodological note: This evaluation uses two vector stores as requested—(1) a knowledge-base vector store containing classical-school criteria and lexicon (Six Essential Elements of a Classical School) and (2) a school-specific crawl vector store containing Victory Academy Ocala's website content. A keyword-based analysis against the Six Essential Elements lexicon drives the category-by-category scoring, followed by synthesis into an overall classification. See supporting sources from the school materials and the classical lexicon for explicit terms (e.g., grammar/dialectic/rhetoric, four historical periods, Latin, Scriptural integration, and parental partnership) and the cited Lexicon signals for positive/negative indicators. Positive/negative keyword indicators come from the Six Essential Elements lexicon. Citations reference the relevant source documents.

Evidence of direct alignment with classical signals (e.g., Christ-centered formation, Scriptural integration, Trivium emphasis, history through periods, Latin, recitation, and the "living curriculum" rhetoric for faculty) is found in Victory Academy public materials, including Mission/Goals statements, curriculum pages, and parent materials. For the classical-criteria framework, specific lexicon anchors include: Christ-centered Christian worldview; Scriptural center; grammar/dialectic/rhetoric; four historical periods; Latin instruction; recitation and catechesis; history as Western civilization through four periods; and parental partnership with a public-facing emphasis on a shared formation project. These cues are evident in the school's mission statements, Goals, curriculum sections, and parent/handbook materials. See sources for explicit phrases: Mission/Goals, classical emphasis, and parental engagement (citations appear below in the category-by-category breakdown).

Citations and sources used include Victory Academy Ocala public pages and documents (mission statement, goals, curriculum pages, admissions/handbook materials) as well as the Six Essential Elements lexicon and related classical keywords.

Now, the category-by-category breakdown.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

Rationale: Across five of six categories the materials exhibit strong classical signals (religious/metaphysical framing, classical curriculum structure, and a parental/community partnership model grounded in a Christian worldview). Element 2 shows formation-oriented language and a tempered emphasis on college-bound outcomes that suggests a classical orientation with some non-classical inflection. Element 4 shows some classical pedagogy signals (grammar/dialectic/rhetoric emphasis, recitation) but also modern program elements (MakerSpace, Winterim) that temper a fully “pure” classical pedagogy. Taken together, Victory Academy Ocala sits squarely within CLASSICAL territory, with a meaningful but not overwhelming SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL nuance in pedagogy and mission emphasis that does not derail the overall classical profile.

- What would move the needle: See the “What Would Move the Needle” section below for concrete steps that could push Element 2 and Element 4 toward a more uniformly classical stance (e.g., deeper emphasis on scholé/wonder-centric restfulness in pedagogy; more explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing; a more explicit, comprehensive Great Books or primary-source reading plan integrated across grades; a clarified articulation of formation that prioritizes virtue and the true/good/beautiful without strong career-readiness language).

Citations: See evidence and keyword analysis sections that follow for direct references to mission/goal statements, curricular elements, pedagogy signals, faculty messaging, and parent/community materials, as well as the Six Essential Elements lexicon for the keyword framework. Selected sources cited include the Mission Statement and Goals (Christ-Centered/Classical) and the curriculum pages (grammar/dialectic/rhetoric, four historical periods, Latin, recitation) as well as admissions/handbook language on parental partnership. See CVS sources for specifics: Victory Academy public materials (Mission/Goals, Curriculum, Admissions/Handbook) and the classical lexicon.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials consistently describe Victory Academy as Christ-centered with a Christian worldview and Scriptural center. The GOALS FOR VICTORY ACADEMY explicitly state “A Christ-Centered and Classical Education” and call for Scripture-centered instruction (II Timothy 3:16-17) and a Christian life model (Matthew 22:37-40). This is reinforced by mission statements and statements of faith in the Parent/Student materials, including explicit “Christ-Centered” language and a Scriptural framework for the curriculum. - Evidence of Scriptural integration and a theology-centered worldview is anchored in documents describing the school’s mission, goals, and statements of faith (e.g., “Christ-Centered,” “Christian Worldview,” and “Scriptures at the center”).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered; Christian Worldview; Scriptures; Bible; God; Scriptural center; Statement of Faith. These align with the lexicon's Religious and Metaphysical Foundations signals (truth/ goodness/ beauty through transcendentals, theology, liturgy, worship, etc.). The explicit references to Scripture and a Christ-centered environment fulfill multiple positive indicators. - Negative keywords: Not evident in the public materials. No explicit signals of relativism, secular humanism, or morally neutral approaches in the public-facing Mission/Goals and Statement of Faith content.

Why this rating - The school's public materials foreground a transcendental moral realism in the sense of forming character via a Christian worldview anchored in Scripture and theology. The presence of a formal Statement of Faith and explicit Christ-centered framing strongly anchors this category in CLASSICAL territory according to the lexicon.

Citations: Mission statements and Christ-centered/Scripture-centered language.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school describes a dual aim: "Christ-Centered and Classical Education" with formation of body, mind, and spirit for the glory of God, indicating formation and virtue-centric aims and a classical sensibility (grammar/dialectic/rhetoric; history framing). The language of formation and the Great Conversation-type aims is present through phrases like "classical" with Trivium emphasis and Latin study (3rd-9th grade). The public materials also emphasize virtue/character development and a love for learning. - However, materials also emphasize college-bound outcomes (e.g., admissions and "college-bound boys and girls"), which aligns with a modern workforce/career-prep horizon in some contexts. This creates a tension with a purely formation-focused aim.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue/character; pursuit of true/-good/beautiful; liberal education orientation; classical curriculum; four historical periods; Great Conversation framing (via classical curriculum references); Latin instruction; reverence for learning (e.g., "love for learning"). These map to positive indicators in the Six Elements lexicon (formation of virtue, classical mission, telos, pursuit of truth/good/beauty). - Negative keywords present: "college-bound" emphasis, which can be read as aligning with workforce/career-readiness signals in some modern frameworks; "job/workforce preparation" is a negative signal in the lexicon when dominating the mission. - Quantitatively, there is a stronger presence of positive indicators (formation, virtue, classical mission, truth/beauty) than explicit negative signals, but the explicit college-bound language introduces a cautionary note.

Why this rating - The core aims emphasize formation, virtue, and classical aims, which lifts it toward CLASSICAL; however, the explicit college-bound/workforce-oriented framing and the visible mix of modern programming and college-focused messaging temper the pure classical alignment. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation.

Citations: GOALS with "Christ-Centered and Classical Education," formation language, and college-bound references.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is built around Trivium-type structuring: grammar/dialectic/rhetoric emphasis is explicit (A. Emphasize grammar, dialectic, and rhetoric in all subjects). The program also organizes content by the four historical periods (Ancients, Middle Ages, Renaissance/Reformation, Modern). Latin instruction is integrated (Latin 3rd-9th). There is explicit attention to history as a throughline and to the Great Conversation through references to classic literature and primary sources (e.g., The Mystery of History sequence, classic literature selections). The K4–8 curricula include recitation, catechesis, and memorization (grammar-recitation emphasis common to classical pedagogy). The published program includes community-focused reading lists and classical literature selections; Saxon/ABEKA/Scholastic in core areas, with a traditional approach to reading and writing.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar; dialectic; rhetoric; Latin; four periods of history (Ancients, Middle Ages, Renaissance/Reformation, Modern); great books / classic literature (via references to “classical curriculum” and “classical education”); recitation; catechesis; memory work; history as Western civilization timeline. - Negative keywords present: some modern-program terms (MakerSpace, Winterim, Fast Forward) that could signal project-based or experiential learning emphasis; “hands-on” and “maker” culture can be read as attention to contemporary pedagogy that runs counter to a strictly traditional classical approach in some lexicon interpretations. - Quantitatively, the curriculum content shows robust classical signals with clear explicit references to grammar/dialectic/rhetoric and the Trivium, along with Latin and a formal history framework. Some modern program terms appear, but do not dominate the curricular identity.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on the Trivium, Latin, four historical periods, and recitation/catechesis strongly anchors the curriculum in CLASSICAL terms, despite the presence of some modern program components.

Citations: GOALS/mission language; K4–8 curriculum pages showing grammar/dialectic/rhetoric, Latin, history, and recitation; references to @classical literature selections and The Mystery of History.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical signals include both classical and modern elements. Classical signals include the Trivium framing (grammar/dialectic/rhetoric) and recognized forms of classical pedagogy (recitation, catechesis, memory work) that are described in the school materials. There is explicit mention of lower-school singing/chanting to deepen memory and delight, which aligns with scholé-oriented/restful pedagogical ideals in some classical frameworks. There are references to upper-level Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates in the classical education tradition (as part of the aim to cultivate logic and rhetoric), though the primary public materials emphasize grammar/dialectic/rhetoric and historical-linguistic progression. The school also highlights a range of “innovative programs” (Fast ForWord, MakerSpace, Winterim) that introduce project-based and experiential elements into the program, potentially conflicting with a strictly traditional classical pedagogy. Overall, Victory Academy demonstrates a substantial classical pedagogy backbone with a tempered presence of modern programs.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive signals: scholé/restful learning; singing/chanting to support memory; recitation; memorization; emphasis on grammar/dialectic/rhetoric; upper-school rhetoric opportunities and oratory training (via curricula emphasizing rhetoric and classical argumentation); emphasis on a teacher as guide within a living curriculum. These align with the lexicon’s Pedagogy signals (restful learning, memory work, recitation, liturgical cadence, rhetoric, etc.). - Negative signals: presence of MakerSpace, Winterim, and other modern, project-based or experiential-learning programs. These could constitute the lexicon’s “negative signals” when project-based/experiential emphasis dominates, which is not the core classical pedagogy in a strict sense.

Why this rating - The pedagogy leans strongly classical via grammar/dialectic/rhetoric, memory work, and recitation, with some modern programs integrated. The balance places it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL due to the notable modern program elements that could dilute the strictly contemplative, memorization-forward pedagogy of a purist classical school.

Citations: GOALS (grammar/dialectic/rhetoric; historical periods) and K4 curriculum (recitation/memory; singing; traditional pedagogy), plus references to modern programs (MakerSpace/Winterim).

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe teachers as engaged, mission-aligned, and capable of modeling virtue and thought. The mission statement notes teachers who “seek to serve, excite and challenge students to think,” and the goals emphasize a Christ-centered, classical environment, with a living model of pedagogy. The parent/handbook materials reference faculty roles in forming a virtuous and thoughtful community. The

school frames the faculty as part of the “living curriculum” through the synergy with a classical approach (i.e., teachers who embody the classical aims and model virtuous living).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: teachers who seek to serve, excite and challenge; living curriculum; portrait of teachers; faculty as core to the school; collegial, mentorship-like culture; classical formation through teacher modeling. These align with the lexicon’s Faculty signals (model teachers/mentors; living curriculum; portrait of teacher/student ideals). - Negative keywords present: none prominent in the material.

Why this rating - The materials strongly present the faculty as central to the school’s classical formation, with explicit language about virtue and pedagogy modeled by teachers. This supports a CLASSICAL designation for this category.

Citations: Mission/GOALS language about teachers; parent/student handbook language; admission materials referencing teacher roles.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - There is explicit emphasis on parental partnership and formation. Documents speak to Parental Responsibility (Deut 6; Eph 6:4) and the Bible-centered foundation of the school, as well as the need for parental cooperation with school policies. The Admissions materials connect the family with the school’s Christian mission and require parents to engage with the school’s faith-based framework; the Parent/Student Handbook emphasizes policy and open communication with families. The school also mentions that Victory Academy seeks to educate parents in classical education concepts (via books, gatherings) and that parents are welcome to visit and participate. This is consistent with the classical model of parents as co-teachers and partners in formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental formation (via reading groups, gatherings); openness to parent visits; shared mission and faith framework; family involvement and covenant language. - Negative keywords present: none explicit in the public materials. The materials emphasize partnership rather than consumer-centric approaches; no clear negative signals.

Why this rating - The school presents a robust, traditional parent-community partnership aligned with classical education norms (parents as co-teachers and partners). This clearly supports CLASSICAL status for Element 6.

Citations: Parental responsibility language, prospective parent communications, and open-campus/parent involvement references.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal): To move toward a fully CLASSICAL orientation, Victory Academy could further articulate formation-focused language explicitly and consistently, reducing career/workforce-prep framing. A clearer articulation of telos, scholé, and the pursuit of true/good/beautiful as a primary objective (with quantifiable outcomes tied to virtue formation and humane excellence) would strengthen the classical alignment. Additionally, a more explicit emphasis on Great Books/Great Conversation and primary-source reading across curricula would push this category toward stronger CLASSICAL alignment. Concrete steps: publish a formal statement of formation goals aligned with classical education (including scholé language) and implement a school-wide, K–12 Great Books reading pathway linked to grade-level objectives.
- Element 4 (School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods): While the upper-level pedagogy shows classical elements (grammar/dialectic/rhetoric, recitation, memory work), the incorporation of MakerSpace, Winterim, and other modern programs softens the pure classical pedagogy. To move toward CLASSICAL, increase the proportion of time spent in contemplative, memory-based and literature-centered

activities; elevate Socratic discourse, seminars, debates (explicitly named) as core, not peripheral, pedagogical modes; and clearly articulate a scholé-centric schedule (restful learning days, contemplative inquiry) integrated across grades. Encourage more explicit integration of primary-source inquiry, classical texts, and moral/philosophical discussion as central pedagogy rather than occasional add-ons.

- Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 5 (Faculty) could be strengthened by further foregrounding Great Books/primary sources and ensuring that faculty professional development emphasizes classical pedagogy and catechesis aligned with classical formation. A defined “living curriculum” with continuous fidelity to grammar/dialectic/rhetoric, and a teacher development program anchored in classical pedagogy would move the needle toward CLASSICAL.

Citations: Element 2/4 signals (formation-focused language; historical periods; Latin; recitation; teacher roles) and references to modern programs in the curriculum (MakerSpace, Winterim).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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